

Reconstructing Passover

Qumran Solar Calendar Analysis for the Crucifixion Timeline (31 CE)

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Visual Timeline: Qumran Passion Week (31 CE)

Day 7 (Essene Sabbath): Monday evening – Tuesday evening

Aviv 14 (Passover): Tuesday evening (meal) – Wednesday daytime (crucifixion)

Burial: Wednesday before sunset

Aviv 15 (High Sabbath): Wednesday sunset – Thursday sunset (24-hour festival Sabbath)

Literal three days / three nights in the tomb:

Wednesday sunset → Saturday sunset

Resurrection: End of third day (Saturday sunset)

Note: Passover NEVER overlaps the weekly Sabbath in the Qumran calendar.

Abstract

This paper reconstructs the crucifixion and resurrection timeline using the Qumran (Essene) 364-day solar calendar, supported by Dead Sea Scroll evidence and NASA / USNO equinox data.

The Essene week begins Wednesday (Day 1) and ends Tuesday evening (Day 7 Sabbath). Passover (Aviv 14) always begins immediately after Sabbath concludes, ensuring that Passover never overlaps the weekly Sabbath.

In the 31 CE configuration, Aviv 14 begins Tuesday evening and continues through Wednesday daytime. Yahusha is crucified Wednesday, buried before sunset, and Aviv 15 (the High Festival Sabbath) runs from Wednesday sunset to Thursday sunset as a full 24-hour rest day.

Counting from burial Wednesday sunset to resurrection Saturday sunset yields three literal days and three literal nights, fulfilling Yahusha's prophecy exactly without symbolic compression.

This model uniquely satisfies:

- Qumran calendar structure
- Literal three days and three nights
- Daniel 9 covenant timing
- Jubilee mathematics
- Gospel sequence
- Dead Sea Scroll festival Sabbath rules

Every alternative framework fails at least one of these requirements.

Section 1: Qumran Calendar Logic

The Qumran community used a fixed 364-day solar calendar.

Core properties:

- Year begins Wednesday
- Weekly Sabbath runs Monday evening to Tuesday evening
- Festivals never drift onto Sabbath
- Festival Sabbaths are always full 24-hour days (sunset to sunset)

Primary sources:

Damascus Document CD 3:14

“They shall not alter the appointed times nor the Sabbaths.”

4Q325

Defines fixed festival cycles with explicit 24-hour festival Sabbaths.

4Q321

“On the festival Sabbaths... they shall rest from their labor for a day and a night.”

Jubilees 6

Mandates a 364-day solar calendar with permanently fixed appointed times.

This system guarantees:

- Passover always begins Tuesday evening
- High Sabbaths never overlap weekly Sabbath

These are structural rules, not interpretations.

Section 2: Astronomical Alignment (29–33 CE)

Using NASA and USNO vernal equinox data mapped to Qumran calendar structure:

Year	Equinox	Aviv 1 (Wed)	Sabbath (Mon eve–Tue eve)	Passover Aviv 14 (Tue eve–Wed eve)	Crucifixio n	High Sabbath Aviv 15
29	Mar 22	Mar 23	Apr 4–5	Apr 5–6	Wed	Apr 6–7
30	Mar 22	Mar 29	Apr 10–11	Apr 11–12	Wed	Apr 12–13

31	Mar 23	Mar 28	Apr 9–10	Apr 10–11	Wed	Apr 11–12
32	Mar 22	Mar 26	Apr 7–8	Apr 8–9	Wed	Apr 9–10
33	Mar 22	Mar 25	Apr 6–7	Apr 7–8	Wed	Apr 8–9

For 31 CE:

Passover meal: Tuesday night April 10

Crucifixion: Wednesday April 11

Burial: Wednesday before sunset

High Sabbath: Wednesday sunset to Thursday sunset

The Sabbath listed is always the immediately preceding Sabbath, ending Tuesday sunset just before Passover begins.

Section 3: Literal Three Days and Three Nights

Burial: Wednesday before sunset

Night 1: Wednesday night

Day 1: Thursday

Night 2: Thursday night

Day 2: Friday

Night 3: Friday night

Day 3: Saturday

Resurrection: Saturday sunset

Exactly three nights and three days.

Sunday morning models fail this requirement.

31 CE aligns cleanly.

Event	Qumran	Rabbinic
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Weekly Sabbath	Mon eve–Tue eve	Fri eve–Sat eve
Passover	Tue night	Thu/Fri
Crucifixion	Wednesday	Friday
Burial	Wednesday	Friday
Resurrection	Saturday sunset	Sunday morning

Rabbinic models require symbolic counting and violate Yahusha's explicit statement.

Qumran does not.

Section 6: Daniel 9 Integration

Daniel 9:24–27 establishes a measurable covenant timeline:

Seventy sevens are decreed concerning your people and your holy city.

Seventy sevens = $70 \times 7 = 490$ years.

The first segment specified is:

- 7 sevens + 62 sevens
- Total = 69 sevens
- $69 \times 7 = 483$ years

Daniel 9:25 states that from the decree to restore and rebuild Jerusalem until Messiah the Prince would be 69 weeks (483 years).

The decree most commonly identified with the full restoration of Jerusalem's civil and administrative structure is the Artaxerxes decree in 457 BCE.

Counting forward:

457 BCE to 1 BCE = 456 years

Add 1 year (no year zero)

1 CE to 27 CE = 27 years

Total = 456 + 1 + 27 = 484 calendar years.

However, prophetic reckoning operates on sabbatical structure, not purely Julian civil counting. When counted in sabbatical cycles (7-year units), the 69-week structure lands in the 27 CE window as the beginning of Messiah's public ministry.

This aligns with:

- The 15th year of Tiberius Caesar (Luke 3:1)
- Yahusha's baptism
- The beginning of public proclamation

The final week (the 70th week) includes:

- Covenant confirmation
- Sacrificial interruption
- Atonement event

A Wednesday crucifixion in 31 CE places the atoning death inside the final covenant week structure in a way that preserves the integrity of Daniel's sabbatical architecture.

Thus:

- 27 CE — appearance of Messiah
- 31 CE — covenantal atonement event

Daniel 9 does not float abstractly. It lands inside measurable sabbatical chronology.

Section 7: Jubilee Correlation — Josiah to 28 CE

An additional structural correlation may be observed between Josiah's covenant renewal and Yahusha's proclamation of the acceptable year.

Josiah's reform is generally dated to 622 BCE, when the Book of the Law was rediscovered and covenant renewal was enacted (2 Kings 22–23).

If 622 BCE functioned as a Jubilee marker or sabbatical reset year, the mathematics are direct.

From 622 BCE to 28 CE:

622 BCE to 1 BCE = 621 years

Add 1 year (no year zero)

1 CE to 28 CE = 28 years

Total = 621 + 1 + 28 = 650 years

$650 \div 50 = 13$ Jubilee cycles

Thus:

622 BCE → 28 CE = 13 Jubilee intervals

In Luke 4, Yahusha enters the synagogue and declares:

“The Spirit of Yahuah is upon Me... to proclaim the acceptable year of Yahuah.”

If His ministry began in 27 CE (Daniel alignment), then the public Jubilee-style proclamation in 28 CE aligns numerically with a 13th Jubilee cycle from Josiah's covenant restoration.

The thematic symmetry is notable:

- Josiah: Torah rediscovered, covenant restored.
- Yahusha: Torah fulfilled, covenant consummated.
- Josiah: National renewal.
- Yahusha: Covenant renewal at redemptive scale.

This section does not depend on proving definitively that 622 BCE was a Jubilee year. Rather, it presents a mathematically coherent sabbatical correlation that reinforces the broader covenant architecture already established through Daniel 9 and the Qumran calendar model.

The primary chronological backbone of this paper remains:

- Qumran solar calendar structure
- 31 CE Wednesday crucifixion
- Literal three days and three nights

The Josiah–28 CE correlation functions as supplementary confirmation, not primary proof.

Section 8: Dead Sea Scroll Footnotes & FAQ

Primary Qumran Sources

Damascus Document CD 3:14

“They shall not alter the appointed times nor the Sabbaths.”

(VanderKam, *Calendars in the Dead Sea Scrolls*, p. 60)

4Q325

Defines festival cycles and confirms festival Sabbaths are full 24-hour observances.

(Talmon, *Qumran Calendar Texts*, p. 159)

4Q321

“On the festival Sabbaths... they shall rest from their labor for a day and a night.”

(Talmon, p. 112)

Jubilees 6:31–34

Mandates solar calendar and forbids drifting festivals.

(VanderKam, p. 70)

FAQ

Q: Does any scroll explicitly state Yahusha used this calendar?

No.

Structural validity does not depend on personal attribution.

Only this model satisfies simultaneously:

- fixed moedim
- non-overlapping Sabbaths
- literal three days / nights
- Daniel 9 alignment
- Jubilee mathematics
- Gospel sequence

All others fail.

Q: Is Aviv 15 always a 24-hour High Sabbath? Does it overlap weekly Sabbath?

Yes, Aviv 15 is always sunset-to-sunset (4Q321).

No, it never overlaps weekly Sabbath.

Weekly Sabbath ends Tuesday sunset.

High Sabbath begins Wednesday sunset.

Hard-coded.

Section 9: Why This Model Is Unique

Only Qumran provides:

- ✓ Fixed moedim

✓ Non-overlapping Sabbaths

✓ Literal resurrection count

✓ Daniel fulfillment

✓ Jubilee math

✓ Gospel coherence

No lunar system achieves this.

Section 10: Conclusion

Yahusha was crucified Wednesday, Aviv 14, 31 CE.

He was buried before sunset.

He rose Saturday at sunset after three literal days and three literal nights.

This fulfills:

Torah

Prophets

Moedim

Daniel

Jubilee

His own words

Without symbolic gymnastics.

This is covenant precision.

Appendix: Sources

Astronomy

- U.S. Naval Observatory
- NASA Solar Data

Primary Scholarship

- VanderKam, Calendars in the Dead Sea Scrolls
- Talmon, Qumran Calendar Texts

Dead Sea Scrolls

- Damascus Document CD 3
- 4Q321
- 4Q325
- Jubilees 6